



YOU ARE **13 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

184 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

At this stage the head, although still large, has a much more rounded shape than before and, as the jaw and neck lengthen, the chin moves away from the neck. An ultrasound now will show the thumb as distinct from the fingers.

“It’s only a minor pregnancy symptom, but nasal congestion can happen most days—and make you a snorer at night!”

Is your partner nudging you in the night because you’re keeping them awake? It’s common for pregnant women to snore. This is largely due to increased swelling of the nasal passages, but it can also be caused by increased weight and the fact that you may roll over onto your back during the night.

Your stuffy nose is due to the increased volume of blood in your body while you’re pregnant. This can cause congestion and make your ears feel blocked, too. Nosebleeds are also very common in pregnancy; some women find that every time they blow their nose they have a small amount of bleeding. This is because the blood vessels in the nose are very fragile, and with the increased volume of blood flowing through them, they tend to bleed more easily. However, the bleeding should be very light.

To treat a nosebleed, tip your head forward and pinch the middle of your nose (in the soft part) hard. It should stop quickly. If it doesn’t, try an icepack on the nose to help the blood vessels constrict. In the rare situation of heavy bleeding, go to the hospital. Seek medical advice if you are getting heavy bleeding regularly.

FOCUS ON PARTNERS

During the first trimester, you probably anxiously awaited developments in the pregnancy and supported your partner when the going got tough. Now that her early pregnancy symptoms such as nausea, sickness, and fatigue are likely to have passed, and the risk of miscarriage is reduced, you may begin to feel differently about the pregnancy and your future.

As your partner starts to show increasing strength and vigor, and as you begin to notice her changing body shape and belly, you may find that the reality of the pregnancy hits you and your sense of trepidation is replaced by optimism as you both look forward.

ASK A NUTRITIONIST
